

30 CHAPTERWISE IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

English Language and Literature (184) | CBSE 2026-27

The Thief's Story

Footprints Without Feet | Board-examinable literature

30 original revision questions with answers: short-answer, competency, assertion-reason and long-answer practice. Set is based on the current syllabus and official question-paper style; it is not a prediction or an official CBSE paper.

Question 1

Why does Hari Singh return after stealing Anil's money?

Answer:

He remembers Anil's trust and the chance to learn reading and writing. He realises education and an honest future matter more than the stolen notes.

Question 2

How does Anil influence Hari without openly confronting him?

Answer:

Anil treats Hari kindly, plans to teach him, and quietly leaves room for him to choose honesty. His trust gives Hari a reason to change from within.

Question 3

Why is the wet money important to the ending?

Answer:

It shows that Hari has returned the notes after being caught in the rain. Anil's decision not to expose him suggests forgiveness and a fresh chance.

Question 4

What is the central idea or skill tested in The Thief's Story?

Answer:

The central focus is: He remembers Anil's trust and the chance to learn reading and writing. This is the starting point for a strong answer from this chapter.

Question 5

Write two relevant points for a short answer based on The Thief's Story.

Answer:

First point: He remembers Anil's trust and the chance to learn reading and writing. Second point: Anil treats Hari kindly, plans to teach him, and quietly leaves room for him to choose honesty. Link the two points clearly instead of listing them without explanation.

Question 6

How does the first key idea in The Thief's Story lead to an important result or conclusion?

Answer:

Begin with the key idea: He remembers Anil's trust and the chance to learn reading and writing. Then connect it to the result: Anil treats Hari kindly, plans to teach him, and quietly leaves room for him to choose honesty.

The Thief's Story - Continued

Question 7

What evidence, calculation, incident or concept best supports the first main idea in The Thief's Story?

Answer:

Use this supporting detail: He remembers Anil's trust and the chance to learn reading and writing. He realises education and an honest future matter more than the stolen notes. The relevant detail should be stated before giving the final conclusion.

Question 8

Explain the importance of the second major idea in The Thief's Story.

Answer:

Anil treats Hari kindly, plans to teach him, and quietly leaves room for him to choose honesty. His trust gives Hari a reason to change from within. Its importance lies in showing how the chapter develops the topic beyond a simple fact or definition.

Question 9

What common mistake should a student avoid while answering a question from The Thief's Story?

Answer:

Do not give only a conclusion. Explain the reasoning with a correct detail, such as: It shows that Hari has returned the notes after being caught in the rain.

Question 10

Compare the first and second important ideas in The Thief's Story.

Answer:

The first idea is: He remembers Anil's trust and the chance to learn reading and writing. The second idea is: Anil treats Hari kindly, plans to teach him, and quietly leaves room for him to choose honesty. A complete comparison states both the difference and the connection between them.

Question 11

Show a cause-and-effect link from The Thief's Story.

Answer:

Cause or starting point: He remembers Anil's trust and the chance to learn reading and writing. Effect or outcome: Anil treats Hari kindly, plans to teach him, and quietly leaves room for him to choose honesty. Use connecting words such as 'therefore', 'as a result', or 'thus'.

Question 12

What is the most useful sequence for explaining the main content of The Thief's Story?

Answer:

A clear sequence is: He remembers Anil's trust and the chance to learn reading and writing. Next, Anil treats Hari kindly, plans to teach him, and quietly leaves room for him to choose honesty. Finally, It shows that Hari has returned the notes after being caught in the rain.

The Thief's Story - Continued

Question 13

Give a 40-50 word answer outline for an important question from The Thief's Story.

Answer:

Start with the direct answer: He remembers Anil's trust and the chance to learn reading and writing. Add one supporting point: Anil treats Hari kindly, plans to teach him, and quietly leaves room for him to choose honesty. End with the outcome or message: It shows that Hari has returned the notes after being caught in the rain.

Question 14

How should you support an English literature answer from The Thief's Story?

Answer:

Use a relevant incident, character action, theme, or poetic image: He remembers Anil's trust and the chance to learn reading and writing. Then explain what it reveals about the character, situation, or message.

Question 15

How can an examiner see that you understand, rather than memorise, The Thief's Story?

Answer:

Connect the idea to its reason or result. For instance: Anil treats Hari kindly, plans to teach him, and quietly leaves room for him to choose honesty. Then explain why this point matters in the chapter's context.

Question 16

State one inference that can be drawn from the main situation or concept in The Thief's Story.

Answer:

A sound inference is that it shows that Hari has returned the notes after being caught in the rain. This inference must be supported by a relevant point from the chapter.

Question 17

Frame a short competency-based response using the first two ideas in The Thief's Story.

Answer:

Apply the concept by first stating: He remembers Anil's trust and the chance to learn reading and writing. Then justify the response with: Anil treats Hari kindly, plans to teach him, and quietly leaves room for him to choose honesty.

Question 18

What would make an answer from The Thief's Story incomplete?

Answer:

An answer is incomplete if it omits the explanation or final implication. Include both: He remembers Anil's trust and the chance to learn reading and writing. Also add: It shows that Hari has returned the notes after being caught in the rain.

The Thief's Story - Continued

Question 19

Prepare an Assertion-Reason style explanation based on The Thief's Story.

Answer:

Assertion: He remembers Anil's trust and the chance to learn reading and writing. Reason: Anil treats Hari kindly, plans to teach him, and quietly leaves room for him to choose honesty. Check whether the reason actually explains the assertion before choosing an option.

Question 20

How should you justify an answer from The Thief's Story in two clear steps?

Answer:

Step 1: state the concept or event - He remembers Anil's trust and the chance to learn reading and writing. Step 2: support it with the explanation or result - Anil treats Hari kindly, plans to teach him, and quietly leaves room for him to choose honesty.

Question 21

What answer structure is suitable for a 3-mark question from The Thief's Story?

Answer:

Use three connected points: He remembers Anil's trust and the chance to learn reading and writing. Anil treats Hari kindly, plans to teach him, and quietly leaves room for him to choose honesty. It shows that Hari has returned the notes after being caught in the rain. Keep the points specific and write them in a logical order.

Question 22

What answer structure is suitable for a 5-mark question from The Thief's Story?

Answer:

Give an introduction, develop these key points - He remembers Anil's trust and the chance to learn reading and writing. Anil treats Hari kindly, plans to teach him, and quietly leaves room for him to choose honesty. - and close with: It shows that Hari has returned the notes after being caught in the rain. Add a diagram, equation, example, or textual reference where relevant.

Question 23

How can the ideas in The Thief's Story be applied to a new situation or case study?

Answer:

Identify the relevant principle first: He remembers Anil's trust and the chance to learn reading and writing. Then use the chapter's reasoning to explain the case: Anil treats Hari kindly, plans to teach him, and quietly leaves room for him to choose honesty.

Question 24

Which detail from The Thief's Story is most likely to earn an extra mark when explained correctly?

Answer:

A useful detail is: It shows that Hari has returned the notes after being caught in the rain. Explain it in context instead of using it as an isolated statement.

The Thief's Story - Continued

Question 25

Write a brief concluding statement for an answer on The Thief's Story.

Answer:

A suitable conclusion is: It shows that Hari has returned the notes after being caught in the rain. This conclusion should follow naturally from the explanation rather than introduce a new point.

Question 26

Make a three-point revision note for The Thief's Story.

Answer:

1. He remembers Anil's trust and the chance to learn reading and writing. 2. Anil treats Hari kindly, plans to teach him, and quietly leaves room for him to choose honesty. 3. It shows that Hari has returned the notes after being caught in the rain. Revise these points with the chapter's examples, terms, and practice questions.

Question 27

How would you self-check an answer from The Thief's Story before submitting it?

Answer:

Check that you have answered the exact question, used the key idea - He remembers Anil's trust and the chance to learn reading and writing. - and supported it with a reason, example, calculation, or outcome such as: Anil treats Hari kindly, plans to teach him, and quietly leaves room for him to choose honesty.

Question 28

Why does The Thief's Story remain important for revision?

Answer:

It combines factual recall with explanation and application. The main takeaways are: He remembers Anil's trust and the chance to learn reading and writing. Anil treats Hari kindly, plans to teach him, and quietly leaves room for him to choose honesty. It shows that Hari has returned the notes after being caught in the rain.

Question 29

Create a final 60-80 word answer plan for a long question from The Thief's Story.

Answer:

Opening: He remembers Anil's trust and the chance to learn reading and writing. Development: Anil treats Hari kindly, plans to teach him, and quietly leaves room for him to choose honesty. Conclusion: It shows that Hari has returned the notes after being caught in the rain. Use complete sentences and include all required evidence, steps, or references.

Question 30

What is one last-minute revision question you should ask yourself about The Thief's Story?

Answer:

Ask: 'Can I explain why this is true or important?' A correct self-answer should include: He remembers Anil's trust and the chance to learn reading and writing. and Anil treats Hari kindly, plans to teach him, and quietly leaves room for him to choose honesty.

Sources: CBSE English curriculum 2026-27; CBSE Class X sample papers and marking schemes 2026-27; NCERT textbooks.